

By Flowing Streams in Babylon

Psalm 137

- 1 By flowing streams in Babylon,
when we remembered Zion there,
we sat down and we wept in grief;
on willows there we hung our harps.
- 2 For there our captors called for songs,
our cruel tormentors asked for mirth.
They called for us to sing to them:
“Come, sing us one of Zion’s songs!”
- 3 But how can we the Lord’s song sing,
when we are in a foreign land?
If I forget Jerusalem,
let my right hand forget its skill!
- 4 O let my tongue to my palate
cleave if I do not remember you,
if I set not Jerusalem
above my greatest, highest joy.
- 5 Remember Edom’s sons, O Lord,
who uttered in Jerus’lem’s day,
“O lay it bare, O lay it bare!
Destroy down to the ground its base.”
- 6 O Babel’s daughter, doomed to die,
blest be the one repaying you.
Blest he who takes your little ones
and dashes them against the rock!

Words: OPC/URCNA 2016

Music: Lowell Mason, 1824

Tune: HAMBURG · LM · Scripture: Psalm 137

Public domain.